CHETAN GAIKAR

DevOps Lead | Cloud Infrastructure & Site Reliability Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

DevOps Lead with 9+ years of experience designing, building, and operating highly available, resilient cloud-native infrastructure on AWS, with additional depth in Azure. Specializes in Infrastructure as Code (Terraform), Kubernetes platform engineering (including Amazon EKS), and CI/CD pipeline design for secure, efficient software delivery. Proven track record of DevOps leadership through complex migrations, platform modernization, and cost optimization initiatives, including a 40% reduction in operating expenses and a multi-tenant release management overhaul using AWS API Gateway. Focused on building infrastructure that scales reliably, fails predictably, and is engineered for operational excellence and site reliability.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS, Microsoft Azure (IaaS, PaaS), Digital Ocean, VPC, IAM
- Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, Terraform Cloud, Packer, Ansible, CloudFormation, ARM Templates
- CI/CD & Automation: Jenkins, GitLab CI, AWS CodePipeline, Azure DevOps, Bitbucket CI
- Azure Services: Azure Monitor, Log Analytics (KQL), Azure Key Vault, Azure Container Registry, Azure Networking (VNet, NSG, Firewall, Private Endpoints, ExpressRoute), Azure Policy, Microsoft Defender for Cloud
- Containers & Platform Engineering: Docker, Kubernetes, Amazon EKS, Amazon ECR, Amazon ECS, GitOps
- Development & Automation: Python, Bash, Git
- Security & Compliance: Cloud Security (SecOps), Identity & Access Management (IAM), HashiCorp Vault, SOC 2
- Observability & Operations: Grafana, AWS CloudWatch, Azure Monitor, Log Analytics (KQL), Datadog, PagerDuty
- Databases: NoSQL, SQL
- Practices: Site Reliability Engineering (SRE), Incident Management, Microservices Architecture, Server & Infrastructure Migration, Disaster Recovery, High Availability

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Onov8 LLC FZ – ***Dubai, UAE***

Lead DevOps Engineer – March 2025 – March 2026

- Led design and maintenance of CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins for multiple applications, improving deployment reliability and reducing manual steps.
- Managed and built AWS ECS infrastructure with Terraform and Packer, including autoscaling spot workloads for cost efficiency.
- Conducted SecOps-focused security reviews across cloud infrastructure, pipelines, and source code, and implemented remediation plans.
- Developed Python and shell automation scripts for operational tasks, migrations, and disaster recovery activities.
- Administered AWS Organizations, networking best practices, and multi-account deployment strategies.
- Technically led a team of 5 DevOps engineers, translating business requirements into DevOps execution plans.
- Built, secured, and optimized government project infrastructure on AWS, reducing turnaround time (TAT) and operating expenses.
- Led a proof-of-concept migrating a subset of containerized workloads from AWS ECS to Amazon EKS, benchmarking cluster provisioning, autoscaling, and deployment workflows against the existing ECS setup to inform a broader platform modernization roadmap.
- Set up Grafana dashboards for infrastructure and pipeline observability, giving the team better visibility into deployment health and cutting down time spent tracking down issues.
- Introduced PagerDuty for on-call incident management, setting up escalation policies and alert routing that cut down response time on production issues.

DevOps Consultant – September 2024 – February 2025

Project: *EZMS v3 (UAE Free Zone ERP)*

Independent DevOps Consultant – ***Remote (Freelance / Self-Employed)***
DevOps Consultant – February 2023 – January 2025

- Built and maintained GitOps-driven CI/CD pipelines using GitLab CI for distributed, multi-service applications.
- Created and maintained deployment pipelines using AWS CodePipeline and related services.
- Designed and managed AWS ECS infrastructure using Terraform, Terraform Cloud, and Packer.
- Deployed and administered Kubernetes clusters on Amazon EKS, handling cluster upgrades, node group autoscaling, and migrating containerized microservices over from ECS to Kubernetes.
- Managed container image lifecycle on Amazon ECR, including repository policies and image scanning, and wired it into CI/CD pipelines for automated builds and deployments to EKS.
- Performed SecOps audits on pipelines, runners, and cloud infrastructure, closing critical security gaps.
- Applied security best practices across cloud infrastructure, GitLab runners, and source code management.
- Supported multi-cloud workloads across Digital Ocean, AWS, Aboin, Cloudflare, and Terraform Cloud.
- Extended freelance delivery to Microsoft Azure for select clients, provisioning resource groups, storage accounts, and core networking with Terraform alongside AWS and Digital Ocean workloads.
- Built Azure DevOps multi-stage YAML pipelines with deployment approvals and environment gating, and configured Azure Monitor/Log Analytics alerting for Azure-hosted client applications.
- Reduced operating expenses by approximately 40% for a major analytics aggregation platform.
- Built an email reputation dashboard using AWS Lambda and SQS.

Projects: *Raketech (Analytics platform aggregator), Integix (XBRL platform)*

JRNI – ***Mumbai, India***
Senior DevOps Engineer – August 2022 – January 2023

- Engineered and maintained Jenkins-driven CI/CD pipelines for AWS applications, managing infrastructure with CloudFormation and automating deployments, including Lambda integrations.
- Established GitHub-based branching strategies and GitOps workflows, alongside automated audit controls using Lambda and shell/cron scripting.
- Automated periodic audits of CloudWatch alerts, EBS volumes, DynamoDB throughput, EC2 CPU credits, and RDS backups, with automated notifications to teams.
- Normalized an unorganized AWS account containing 600+ resources, improving reliability and agility while reducing operating expenses by approximately 5%.

Project: *AWS Audit Automation*

Accrete.ai – ***Mumbai, India***
Lead DevOps Engineer – November 2021 – August 2022

- Worked on AI-based recommendation and data-collection platforms using Angular, MongoDB, Python, Elasticsearch, and AWS.
- Suggested and implemented a GitOps-style branching strategy with a robust release cycle for application deployment.
- Administered Linux servers underpinning the platform, including patching, user and permission management, and installation of application agents and web servers.
- Configured monitoring agents (including Datadog for production monitoring), systemd services, and firewall/security hardening measures to maintain uptime and security posture across the Linux environment.

Products: *The Vibe, The Moneyflow, NII*

NEC Software Solutions – ***Mumbai, India***
Senior DevOps Engineer – November 2019 – October 2021

- Supported major publishing clients (IET, Bloomsbury, Emerald) and provided technical guidance and mentorship to associate engineers on additional projects (BPS, FTC, AscenderHCM), acting as a de facto team lead for platform delivery.
- Led Terraform and ARM template-based infrastructure design for Azure environments, provisioning resource groups, storage accounts, and networking components for enterprise client environments.
- Built and managed Azure DevOps CI/CD pipelines using multi-stage YAML, deployment approvals, and environment-based release gating for publishing platform applications.

DevOps Engineer – May 2018 – November 2019

Projects: *IET Career Manager, Zellis Pro-IV, Ascender HCM – Workcloud, PSA (UK), NPS, CVLT, Emerald*

CloudManthan – ***Mumbai, India***

Software Engineer – Cloud Practitioner – May 2016 – April 2018

- Created, managed, and maintained AWS infrastructure.
- Explored and applied cloud best practices across AWS and Azure.

Project: *Athena Public Engagement*

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.), Computer Engineering – July 2011 – June 2015
A. C. Patil College of Engineering, Navi Mumbai, India

PERSONAL PROJECTS

- TerraformSBB — Generic Terraform building blocks to accelerate client-specific infrastructure code (2022 – Present)
- awsRemedies — Python micro-solutions repository for Lambda (e.g., ElastiCache autoscaling, gaps not natively covered by AWS) (2020 – Present)
- Email Reputation Dashboard — Ongoing enhancements to a custom email reputation and deliverability monitoring solution originally built for a client